Although, as said, we won't adopt this example in the rest of the chapter, the zealous reader might use it as a starting point to experiment implementing SS-trees using this pattern.

10.3.1 SS-tree Search

Now we are ready to start describing `SsNode`'s methods; although it would somehow feel natural to start with insertion (we need to build a tree before searching it, after all), it is also true that, as for many tree-based data structures, the first step to insert or delete an entry is searching the node where it should be inserted.

Hence, we will need the `search` method (meant as *exact element search*) before being able to insert a new item. While we will see how this step in the `insert` method is slightly different than plain `search`, it will still be easier to describe it after we have discussed traversing the tree.

Figures 10.10 and 10.11 shows the step of a call to search on our example SS-tree; to be fair, the SS-tree we'll use in the rest of the chapter is derived from the one in figure 10.9: you might notice that there are a few more points (the orange stars), a few of the old points have been slightly moved, and we stripped all the points' labels, replacing them with letters from `A` to `W`, in order to remove clutter and have cleaner diagrams; for the same reason, we'll identify the point to search/insert/delete, in this and the following sections, as `Z` (to avoid clashes with points already in the tree).